NORTHSTAR | PRIVACY INCIDENT TRIAGE

Independent Excel portfolio project • Simulated data breach & document review • October 2026

OBJECTIVE

Build a reproducible, documented framework for preliminary privacy-incident triage: classify document summaries, separate external transmission from unauthorised sharing, record uncertainty, and identify issues requiring further verification.

PROJECT AT A GLANCE

30	11	5	11
synthetic records reviewed	PII-present records	PHI-present records	hypothetical escalations

SCENARIO & SCOPE

Fictional Northstar Solutions Pvt. Ltd. identified a possible misdirected employee-benefits file (incident date: 10 October 2026; assumed discovery: 12 October 2026). The workbook reviews 30 invented summaries of emails, payroll and benefits records, IT alerts, transfer-log descriptions and attachment references. One known duplicate yields 29 identified unique records. No underlying source files were examined.

KEY FINDINGS

• Direct identifiers (PII): 11/30 records classified Present; identifiable health information (PHI): 5/30 classified Present. The categories overlap and should not be added together.

• Potential external sharing: 4 records indicate external transmission and 2 indicate potential external disclosure. These are investigative signals, not six confirmed breaches or six verified unauthorised exposures.

• Authorisation: 10 records are coded Unknown for sharing authorisation, including records with uncertain transmission, blocked delivery or unresolved context. Unknown does not mean unauthorised.

• Escalations: 11 records require hypothetical follow-up, such as checking approved recipients, vendor permissions, delivery/access logs or unreviewed attachments.

• Quality control: 5 records underwent a second self-review; 3/5 matched initially across four coded fields (60%). Two differences were reconciled. This measures initial self-review consistency, not independent accuracy.

KEY SKILLS DEMONSTRATED

Data classification (PII, PHI, financial information) | Incident triage | Regulatory mapping (India DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025) | Quality control | Documentation and Excel reporting

METHOD & REPRODUCIBILITY

The workbook includes an Evidence_Review register, written Review_Protocol, Second_Pass_Review, Escalation_Log, QA_QC audit trail, formula-driven Dashboard and Findings_Summary. Review decisions distinguish Present, Absent and Unclear; external sending, recipient authorisation and escalation are assessed separately.

LIMITATIONS & REGULATORY NOTE

Entirely fictional, self-directed educational work. No real data subjects, client engagement, confirmed personal-data breach, forensic validation or remediation. The DPDP framework is mapped for learning; the applicability and commencement of legal requirements must be checked for any real incident. No notification deadline or affected-person count is asserted from this simulated evidence.